

QuickVault, Inc. v. International Business Machines Corporation

The public complaint describes an endpoint and cloud-data-security dispute concerning discovery and classification of sensitive information, transmission of metadata to Guardium components, monitoring and analysis of user activity, policy enforcement, and remote remediation such as deletion or encryption. The issue map is preliminary and does not offer an infringement, validity, damages, or claim-construction opinion.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-26	U.S. District Court for the Western District of Texas, Austin Division	1:26-cv-02342	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	QuickVault, Inc. v. International Business Machines Corporation
FORUM / DOCKET	U.S. District Court for the Western District of Texas, Austin Division / 1:26-cv-02342
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-26 / patent infringement
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

The public complaint identifies QuickVault, Inc. as plaintiff, International Business Machines Corporation as defendant, Civil Action No. 1:26-cv-02342, and an August 26, 2026 filing date. It alleges infringement of U.S. Patent Nos. 12,363,134; 11,895,125; 11,637,840; 10,999,300; 9,961,092; and 9,565,200 by IBM Guardium products and services. These are allegations, not findings.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

David K. Ludwig - Partner, Hill, Kertscher & Wharton, LLP. Verified docket fact and analytical inference: Ludwig signs the filed complaint as counsel for QuickVault, Inc. and supplies his direct professional email. His role makes him a plausible initial recipient for this preliminary expert-search packet; it does not establish purchasing authority.

dludwig@hkw-law.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

The public complaint describes an endpoint and cloud-data-security dispute concerning discovery and classification of sensitive information, transmission of metadata to Guardium components, monitoring and analysis of user activity, policy enforcement, and remote remediation such as deletion or encryption. The issue map is preliminary and does not offer an infringement, validity, damages, or claim-construction opinion.

Secondary-source limitation: The complaint, related attachments, and public product materials are a starting point only. The actual claims, intrinsic record, accused-product versions, deployment configurations, source code, system logs, and discovery must control any final technical opinion. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 12,363,134](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 11,895,125](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 11,637,840](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 10,999,300](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 9,961,092](#) | [U.S. Patent No. 9,565,200](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Endpoint discovery and classification

What endpoint, server, file-system, database, and cloud-data components discover and classify sensitive data, and which actual data attributes, classifiers, rules, or scans perform the pleaded functions?

Potential evidence: Source code, agent binaries, classifier rules, product documentation, test environments, endpoint and server logs, configuration records, and network traces.

02 Agent-to-platform telemetry path

Do Guardium agents, appliances, collectors, classifiers, and services communicate in the architecture alleged, and what metadata is collected, retained, transformed, or transmitted between components?

Potential evidence: Architecture diagrams, source code, API specifications, protocol captures, agent configurations, appliance settings, logs, and implementation testimony.

03 Data tracking and user-activity analytics

Does the accused system track sensitive information and user activity in a way that supports the pleaded forensic-data-tracking and prediction theories, rather than merely generating ordinary audit events?

Potential evidence: Analytics code, models or rule sets, event schemas, dashboards, alert logic, stored telemetry, reporting artifacts, and controlled testing.

04 Policy enforcement and remote remediation

Which component determines a policy violation and can it effect or direct remediation, including deletion, encryption, access restrictions, alerts, or other endpoint actions?

Potential evidence: Policy engines, workflows, administration guides, source code, role and authorization settings, API calls, endpoint traces, and operational records.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Integrated-platform attribution

Which Guardium products, services, versions, integrations, and customer configurations work together, and which actor performs each claimed function?

Potential evidence: Release notes, product documentation, licensing and deployment records, customer configurations, integration diagrams, source repositories, and technical testimony.

06 Encryption and access-control implementation

Where and how are data protected, keys managed, access decisions made, and encryption or data-protection functions executed across endpoints, databases, and cloud services?

Potential evidence: Encryption design documents, key-management configurations, access-control policies, source code, cryptographic protocol captures, and system logs.

07 Technical baseline and claimed functionality

What would a skilled artisan have understood at the relevant times about endpoint data-loss prevention, data discovery and classification, user-behavior analytics, remote remediation, and enterprise data-security platforms?

Potential evidence: Contemporaneous papers, standards, patents, vendor documentation, source materials, product records, and a supported POSITA definition.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Nick Feamster, PhD

Neubauer Professor of Computer Science and Faculty Director of Research, University of Chicago Data Science Institute

TECHNICAL FIT

Network-security measurement, anomaly detection, data-driven security systems, and enterprise network architecture are closely relevant to Guardium telemetry, analytics, and platform integration.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited University of Chicago profile identifies research on empirical measurement and AI/ML to improve the performance, security, and privacy of networked systems, and prior work on network configuration analysis and botnet detection.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

His public University of Chicago profile states that he serves as an expert witness in technology litigation and has federal trial testimony experience in software patent, copyright, trade-secret, and privacy matters.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited profile supports security-analytics and systems fit but does not establish familiarity with the asserted patents or particular Guardium versions; prior opinions, engagements, and conflicts require separate diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | feamster@uchicago.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Wenke Lee, PhD

USG Regents Professor and John P. Imlay Jr. Chair in Software, Georgia Institute of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Systems and network security, malware analysis, virtual-machine monitoring, mobile security, and detection/mitigation methods fit endpoint instrumentation, telemetry, threat analysis, and policy-enforcement issues.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited Georgia Tech profile identifies more than 100 publications and research projects in botnet detection, malware analysis, virtual-machine monitoring, mobile security, and information-manipulation detection; it also identifies his Damballa co-founding role.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The source does not establish a particular data-loss-prevention or Guardium-product focus; product-specific and prior-opinion diligence is required.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | wenke.lee@cc.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Dawn Song, PhD

Professor of Computer Science, University of California, Berkeley

TECHNICAL FIT

Security and privacy in systems, software, networking, and databases, along with program analysis and encrypted-data work, are relevant to data discovery, classification, data protection, and encryption questions.

RELEVANT WORK

Berkeley identifies Song's work in computer security, privacy, program analysis, and applied cryptography. Her publicly available paper with David Wagner and Adrian Perrig addresses searching encrypted data while protecting data confidentiality.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited materials establish broad security and cryptography fit but not direct knowledge of the accused platform or all forensic-data-tracking claims.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | dawnsong@cs.berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

04 William Enck, PhD

Goodnight Distinguished Professor in Security Sciences, North Carolina State University

TECHNICAL FIT

Systems security across software supply chains, cloud infrastructure, mobile platforms, IoT, and networks fits endpoint-agent operation, platform architecture, telemetry, and deployment questions.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited NC State profile describes Enck as co-director of the Secure Computing Institute and director of the Wolfpack Security and Privacy Research Laboratory, with systems-security research across cloud infrastructure and mobile platforms.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited material does not show a direct focus on enterprise data classification or data-loss-prevention product operation; case-specific fit needs vetting.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | whenck@ncsu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Gene Tsudik, PhD

Distinguished Professor of Computer Science and NetSys Co-Director, University of California, Irvine

TECHNICAL FIT

Security, privacy, and applied cryptography support analysis of protected data, system trust boundaries, data provenance, encryption, and key or authorization architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited UCI profile identifies security, privacy, and applied cryptography research and notes his ACM, IEEE, and AAAS fellowships. Public work includes research concerning data provenance and secure communication.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The apparent fit is strongest for security architecture and cryptographic/data-provenance questions, not necessarily user-behavior analytics or specific commercial Guardium deployments.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | gts@ics.uci.edu | [public email source](#)

06 David Evans, PhD

Olsen Bicentennial Professor of Engineering and Professor of Computer Science, University of Virginia

TECHNICAL FIT

Program analysis and secure data-storage work are relevant to identifying sensitive data, classifying or protecting it in software, and analyzing security-critical data handling.

RELEVANT WORK

Evans's public research page describes automatic identification and protection of security-critical data in real programs using static and dynamic inference and a separate secure store.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The public sources demonstrate research fit but do not establish experience with enterprise data-security appliances, commercial endpoint agents, or damages.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#) | [Source 3](#)

[Draft email](#) | evans@virginia.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Vitaly Shmatikov, PhD

Professor of Computer Science, Cornell Tech and Cornell Ann S. Bowers College of Computing and Information Science

TECHNICAL FIT

Digital privacy, computer security, and security/privacy issues in machine learning are relevant to sensitive-data handling, privacy risk, and security analytics.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited Cornell profile identifies research in digital privacy, computer security, and security and privacy issues in machine learning, as well as recognized work in privacy-enhancing technologies and security.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The cited materials do not show particular expertise in endpoint remote remediation or the accused Guardium product family.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | shmat@cs.cornell.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Lorrie Faith Cranor, PhD

University Professor, Software and Societal Systems, Carnegie Mellon University

TECHNICAL FIT

Usable privacy and security, privacy engineering, and human interaction with security policies are relevant to evaluating administrative controls, policy-setting, alerts, access restrictions, and operational security workflows.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited Carnegie Mellon profile identifies Cranor as director of the CyLab Usable Privacy and Security Laboratory and describes more than 150 papers in usable privacy and security; it also identifies privacy-engineering work and a security-awareness company co-founding role.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The cited Carnegie Mellon profile states that Cranor has served as an expert witness in patent litigation and privacy cases.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Her most direct fit is privacy engineering and user-facing security/policy operation; a different candidate may better cover low-level endpoint implementation or the precise asserted claims.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | lorrie@andrew.cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Nikita Borisov, PhD

Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

TECHNICAL FIT

Computer security and privacy in large-scale distributed systems, privacy-preserving aggregation, secure networks, and information leakage are relevant to distributed data security and metadata/telemetry questions.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited Illinois profile describes research in computer security and privacy for large-scale distributed systems, privacy-preserving data aggregation, and reliable and secure peer-to-peer networks.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The sources do not establish specific data-loss-prevention or enterprise endpoint-agent experience; expert suitability would need claim-by-claim diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | nikita@illinois.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Jennifer Rexford, PhD

Gordon Y.S. Wu Professor of Engineering and Provost, Princeton University

TECHNICAL FIT

Systems and networking, security and privacy, and network architecture are relevant to the agent-to-platform communication path, enterprise integrations, and distributed enforcement or telemetry architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

The cited Princeton profile identifies Rexford's research in systems and networking, security and privacy, and work on making future networks trustworthy; it also notes earlier AT&T Labs-Research experience.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Not stated in the cited public profile; no conclusion is drawn about the existence or absence of other experience.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The public record establishes networking/system expertise rather than a primary focus on endpoint data classification or forensic data tracking; fit depends on the actual asserted claims and accused configuration.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | jrex@cs.princeton.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74709475/quickvault-inc-v-international-business-machines-corporation/>

Public professional email source: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.txwd.1172929761/gov.uscourts.txwd.1172929761.1.0.pdf>

Public technical context source: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.txwd.1172929761/gov.uscourts.txwd.1172929761.1.0.pdf>

LIMITATIONS

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